



Skill 13

Consider Alternative Explanations

What Else Could Explain It?

160 Items	1-5 Levels	Pick another explanation that also fits the facts. Objective
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Essential question. What else could explain the same facts?

This PDF is designed for classroom use. It gives teachers a rigorous introduction to the skill, a repeatable solving routine, likely student confusions, a worked example, and the full XiXteen item set with choice-level feedback.

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Skill 13

Consider Alternative Explanations

What Else Could Explain It?

Pick another explanation that also fits the facts. Objective	160 Items	Levels 1-5 Difficulty bands
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Essential question	What else could explain the same facts?
Why it matters	Good thinkers do not stop at the first explanation that fits. They ask what else could make the same facts true, especially when a conclusion is attractive.
Conceptual core	Alternative explanation thinking is disciplined imagination. Students keep the observed evidence fixed and ask what other story could make it true. This reduces premature closure, especially when the first explanation is emotionally satisfying or easy to remember. The strongest alternative explanation is specific, plausible, and compatible with the given facts.
Student method	Keep the observed facts fixed, then generate another story that could produce them. The best alternative is specific and fits the evidence without contradicting it.
Analogy	Alternative explanations are spare keys. If more than one key opens the same lock, you should not assume you have found the only one.
Assessment focus	A good answer names a plausible alternative that matches the observed facts and avoids unsupported contradictions.

Teaching Sequence

1. Name the observed result without interpreting it.
2. Generate another cause, condition, or selection effect that could produce the same result.
3. Reject alternatives that contradict the prompt.
4. Prefer alternatives that are specific enough to test.

Common Confusions To Watch For

1. Students may offer a random possibility that does not fit the facts.
2. Students may think an alternative explanation must disprove the original explanation.
3. Students may choose a vague phrase like many factors without naming one.

Teacher Prompts

1. What fact are we trying to explain?
2. What other story could make that fact true?
3. How could we test the original explanation against this alternative?

Worked Example

Scenario	A museum's family attendance rises after free Friday admission begins, but a popular dinosaur exhibit opens the same weekend.
Teacher think-aloud	Free admission could matter, but the new exhibit could also explain the attendance increase. Both fit the observed rise, so we need more evidence to separate them.
Student takeaway	An alternative explanation does not have to be proven; it has to plausibly fit the same evidence.

Classroom extension. Have students practice the sentence frame: The result could be due to __, but it could also be due to __.

Item Bank

Items are grouped by level. For each item, read the prompt, predict the answer, choose, and then use the feedback and process commentary to examine the reasoning path.

Level 1

Level 1 establishes the clean version of the skill: the cue is direct, the distractors are visible, and the main task is to learn the contrast.

alternative_explanations-001 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Late-shift commute complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-002 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Classroom disruption reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-003 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Missed-dose reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-004 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Staff resignations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-005 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Shopper overpayment complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-006 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Library card renewals cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-007 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Admin account takeovers cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-008 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Reported thefts cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-009 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The final exam was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Course pass rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-010 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert prices increased at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Dessert orders cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-011 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Overdraft fees cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-012 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Trail crowding complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. A nearby trail reopened that month, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-013 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new children's exhibit opened the same week, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Family visits cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-014 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Repeat head injuries cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The league also shortened the season, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-015 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Donor retention cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-016 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Back-injury claims cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-017 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Trash pickup schedules also changed, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Landfill waste from participating buildings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-018 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Publicly visible profiles cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The app also deleted inactive accounts, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-019 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The clinic also began reminder calls, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Patient no-show rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-020 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Average boarding time cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-021 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Unresolved repair requests cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-022 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A fruit discount started that week, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Fruit purchases cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-023 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Customer complaint rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The call queue was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-024 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Average household water use cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. A rainy season began during the study, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-025 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Missing-camera-footage reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The department also updated supervisor reviews, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-026 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The office also expanded its phone staff, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Phone calls asking ballot status cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-027 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Vocabulary retention quiz scores cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The app also changed the quiz format, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-028 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The gym also discounted annual plans, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. New-member cancellations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-029 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Reported minor crashes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-030 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Reader trust ratings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The newsroom also hired a public editor, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-031 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Price disputes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-032 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The hotel also changed room assignments, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Noise complaints from guest rooms cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

Level 2

Level 2 keeps the same skill but adds more realistic wording and more tempting distractors.

alternative_explanations-033 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Late-shift commute complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d2

- A feedback (Correct):** Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.
- B feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.
- C feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.
- D feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-034 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Classroom disruption reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d2

- A feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.
- B feedback (Correct):** Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.
- C feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.
- D feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-035 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Missed-dose reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-036 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Staff resignations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The company also raised salaries that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-037 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Shopper overpayment complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-038 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The library also opened on Sundays, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Library card renewals cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-039 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Admin account takeovers cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-040 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Reported thefts cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Police patrols increased during the same period, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-041 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Course pass rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The final exam was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-042 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert orders cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Dessert prices increased at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-043 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Overdraft fees cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The bank also changed its fee grace period, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-044 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A nearby trail reopened that month, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Trail crowding complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-045 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Family visits cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. A new children's exhibit opened the same week, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-046 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Repeat head injuries cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The league also shortened the season, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-047 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Donor retention cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-048 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Back-injury claims cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-049 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Landfill waste from participating buildings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Trash pickup schedules also changed, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-050 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Publicly visible profiles cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The app also deleted inactive accounts, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-051 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Patient no-show rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The clinic also began reminder calls, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-052 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Average boarding time cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-053 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Unresolved repair requests cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-054 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A fruit discount started that week, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Fruit purchases cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-055 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Customer complaint rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The call queue was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-056 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Average household water use cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. A rainy season began during the study, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-057 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Missing-camera-footage reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-058 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The office also expanded its phone staff, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Phone calls asking ballot status cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-059 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The app also changed the quiz format, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Vocabulary retention quiz scores cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-060 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. New-member cancellations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The gym also discounted annual plans, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-061 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Reported minor crashes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-062 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The newsroom also hired a public editor, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Reader trust ratings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-063 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The market also added a weekend help desk, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Price disputes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-064 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The hotel also changed room assignments, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Noise complaints from guest rooms cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

Level 3

Level 3 asks for steadier discrimination: the right answer is still objective, but the wrong answers often sound plausible.

alternative_explanations-065 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Late-shift commute complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-066 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Classroom disruption reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-067 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Missed-dose reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-068 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Staff resignations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-069 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Shopper overpayment complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-070 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Library card renewals cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-071 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Admin account takeovers cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-072 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Reported thefts cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-073 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Course pass rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The final exam was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-074 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert prices increased at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Dessert orders cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-075 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Overdraft fees cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-076 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Trail crowding complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. A nearby trail reopened that month, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-077 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new children's exhibit opened the same week, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Family visits cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-078 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The league also shortened the season, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Repeat head injuries cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-079 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Donor retention cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-080 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Back-injury claims cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-081 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Trash pickup schedules also changed, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Landfill waste from participating buildings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-082 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The app also deleted inactive accounts, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Publicly visible profiles cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-083 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Patient no-show rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-084 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Average boarding time cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-085 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Unresolved repair requests cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-086 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Fruit purchases cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. A fruit discount started that week, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-087 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The call queue was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Customer complaint rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-088 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A rainy season began during the study, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Average household water use cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-089 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Missing-camera-footage reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The department also updated supervisor reviews, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-090 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Phone calls asking ballot status cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The office also expanded its phone staff, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-091 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The app also changed the quiz format, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Vocabulary retention quiz scores cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-092 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The gym also discounted annual plans, which could also explain the change. correct	B. New-member cancellations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-093 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Reported minor crashes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-094 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Reader trust ratings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The newsroom also hired a public editor, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-095 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Price disputes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-096 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The hotel also changed room assignments, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Noise complaints from guest rooms cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

Level 4

Level 4 asks learners to hold more context in mind while applying the same method.

alternative_explanations-097 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Late-shift commute complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-098 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Classroom disruption reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-099 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Missed-dose reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-100 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The company also raised salaries that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Staff resignations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-101 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Shopper overpayment complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-102 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Library card renewals cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The library also opened on Sundays, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-103 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Admin account takeovers cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-104 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Police patrols increased during the same period, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Reported thefts cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-105 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The final exam was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Course pass rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-106 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert orders cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. Dessert prices increased at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-107 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Overdraft fees cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The bank also changed its fee grace period, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-108 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. A nearby trail reopened that month, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Trail crowding complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-109 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Family visits cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. A new children's exhibit opened the same week, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-110 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The league also shortened the season, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Repeat head injuries cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-111 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Donor retention cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-112 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Back-injury claims cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-113 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Trash pickup schedules also changed, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Landfill waste from participating buildings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-114 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The app also deleted inactive accounts, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Publicly visible profiles cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-115 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Patient no-show rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The clinic also began reminder calls, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-116 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Average boarding time cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-117 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Unresolved repair requests cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-118 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A fruit discount started that week, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Fruit purchases cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-119 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The call queue was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Customer complaint rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-120 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Average household water use cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. A rainy season began during the study, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-121 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Missing-camera-footage reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-122 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The office also expanded its phone staff, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Phone calls asking ballot status cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-123 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The app also changed the quiz format, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Vocabulary retention quiz scores cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-124 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. New-member cancellations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The gym also discounted annual plans, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-125 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Reported minor crashes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-126 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The newsroom also hired a public editor, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Reader trust ratings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d4

- A feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.
- B feedback (Correct):** Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.
- C feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.
- D feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-127 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Price disputes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The market also added a weekend help desk, which could also explain the change. correct

- Core explanation.** A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.
- Process commentary.** To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d4

- A feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.
- B feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.
- C feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.
- D feedback (Correct):** Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-128 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Noise complaints from guest rooms cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The hotel also changed room assignments, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

- Core explanation.** A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.
- Process commentary.** To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d4

- A feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.
- B feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.
- C feedback (Correct):** Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.
- D feedback (Distractor):** Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

Level 5

Level 5 is for fluency: the learner should now name the thinking move and explain the elimination path.

alternative_explanations-129 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Late-shift commute complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-130 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Classroom disruption reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-131 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Missed-dose reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-132 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Staff resignations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-133 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Shopper overpayment complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-134 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Library card renewals cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-135 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Admin account takeovers cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-136 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Reported thefts cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-137 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Course pass rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The final exam was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-138 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Dessert prices increased at the same time, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Dessert orders cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-139 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The bank also changed its fee grace period, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Overdraft fees cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-140 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Trail crowding complaints cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. A nearby trail reopened that month, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-141 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. Family visits cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. A new children's exhibit opened the same week, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-142 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Repeat head injuries cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The league also shortened the season, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-143 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Donor retention cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-144 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. Back-injury claims cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-145 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Landfill waste from participating buildings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Trash pickup schedules also changed, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-146 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Publicly visible profiles cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The app also deleted inactive accounts, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-147 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls, which could also explain the change. correct	D. Patient no-show rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-148 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Average boarding time cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-149 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians, which could also explain the change. correct
C. Unresolved repair requests cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-150 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A fruit discount started that week, which could also explain the change. correct choice	B. Fruit purchases cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-151 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Customer complaint rates cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The call queue was also shortened, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-152 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Average household water use cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. A rainy season began during the study, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-153 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Missing-camera-footage reports cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	B. The department also updated supervisor reviews, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-154 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The office also expanded its phone staff, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The result includes a percentage. choice
C. Phone calls asking ballot status cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-155 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. Vocabulary retention quiz scores cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice	D. The app also changed the quiz format, which could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-156 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result includes a percentage. choice	B. New-member cancellations cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The gym also discounted annual plans, which could also explain the change. correct	D. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

alternative_explanations-157 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Reported minor crashes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-158 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The newsroom also hired a public editor, which could also explain the change. correct	B. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Reader trust ratings cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

alternative_explanations-159 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk, which could also explain the change. correct	B. Price disputes cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice
C. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	D. The result includes a percentage. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-160 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail must be the only cause of the result. choice	B. The hotel also changed room assignments, which could also explain the change. correct
C. The result includes a percentage. choice	D. Noise complaints from guest rooms cannot change under any circumstances, so no explanation is needed. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. This jumps from a side detail to 'the only cause.' A good alternative explanation fits the facts without overclaiming.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. The setup says the result changed, so saying change is impossible clashes with the facts.